Apart from its overall political goals, Hamas seems to have three specific demands for the release of hostages: an end to the bombing of the enclave, the delivery of fuel, and the liberation of Hamas and Islamic Jihad prisoners in Israeli jails. In response, Hamas could liberate children, women, and old people. Facing this possibility, the Israeli war cabinet is divided between two positions: postponing a ground invasion to prioritize the partial liberation of hostages, or beginning a ground assault and negotiating release of the hostages after achieving some strategic military advantages.

Israeli ground forces are fighting in the enclave. A spokesperson for Netanyahu announced to foreign correspondents that "the turning point has arrived and Hamas will feel the intensity of our anger." It is impossible at this stage to know exactly what is going on and whether the ground operation is "surgical," as the Americans have demanded, or whether it is massive. Iran has declared that fighters in Lebanon "have their finger on the trigger," to use its terms, but one does not know whether Hezbollah will join the war or only fight with Iran's empty words.

Saturday, October 28

Little information about the IDF operation. This is understandable. The *New York Times* writes that Hamas has stockpiled enormous quantities of fuel and provisions in anticipation of a protracted war, even as the population in Gaza lacks the essentials. The organization's constant demand for fuel was just camouflage: it seems to have all it needs for a long war stored along hundreds of miles of tunnels. It has become clear that Egypt was the pipeline for all this hidden traffic. Despite el-Sisi's goodwill facade, hatred of Israel seems to run very deep on the shores of the Nile.

The families of the Israeli hostages are worried about the fate of their loved ones during a ground operation. It appears that after he was informed